

RailCore Growth Pathway Program

Manager & Employee Track Trainer Guide

Creating Meaningful IDPs Through Conversation, Action, and Follow-Up

Core Message

Employees own their development. Managers support the conversation. Leaders reinforce the system.

Trainer Guide Overview

Audience: Managers and employees participating in the Individual Development Plan process.

Duration: 2 hours

Delivery mode: Instructor-led workshop or blended session with guided system practice.

Course type: Application-based IDP workshop.

Prerequisite: Leaders have completed the Leader Track and established the IDP adoption standard through the RailCore IDP Leadership Playbook.

Learning flow: Understand -> Analyze -> Practice -> Apply -> Commit.

Facilitator Mindset

- Keep the session practical and role-based. Avoid turning it into a policy lecture.
- Use the Leader Playbook only to set context. Do not reteach the Leader Track.
- Keep returning to the idea that an IDP is a development conversation supported by a documented plan and follow-up.
- Balance manager and employee perspectives. Both groups have clear responsibilities.
- Use examples and participant drafts as the primary learning materials.

Materials Checklist

- Slide deck
- Participant workbook / worksheets
- IDP Quality Checklist
- IDP Conversation Model and Question Bank
- CRM training environment or screenshots
- Sample IDP scenario: Jordan Lee
- Timer
- Whiteboard or digital collaboration space

Two-Hour Agenda

Section	Topic	Time	Purpose
1	Welcome & Leader Standard	10 min	Connect to RailCore IDP expectations and learning purpose.
2	IDP Journey & Role Clarity	10 min	Clarify shared process and role ownership.
3	What Makes a Strong IDP	20 min	Define quality standards and review examples.
4	Fix the Weak IDP	15 min	Practice improving vague goals and actions.
5	IDP Conversation Model	15 min	Practice focused development conversation language.
6	CRM / System Guided Practice	25 min	Document or review IDPs in the system.
7	Draft or Refine Your Own IDP	20 min	Create a real or realistic IDP component.
8	Peer / Manager Review	10 min	Improve drafts using checklist feedback.
9	Follow-Up Commitment & Close	5 min	Confirm next action and follow-up rhythm.

Detailed Facilitation Plan

Section 1: Welcome & Leader Standard

Time: 10 minutes

Slides: Slides 1-4

Purpose: Open the workshop and connect the Manager & Employee Track to the IDP expectations established by leaders.

Key message: IDPs are not only an HR form or system task. They are a structured development conversation supported by documentation and follow-up.

Facilitator process

- Welcome participants and introduce the course title.
- Explain that this is an application workshop, not a policy lecture.
- Connect briefly to the Leader Playbook: meaningful conversations, quality goals, documentation, and follow-up.
- Ask participants to think about one skill, goal, or capability they may want to develop.

Discussion prompts

- When IDPs are done well, what should change for employees and teams?

Expected participant responses / evidence

- Clearer employee goals
- More consistent development conversations
- Better manager support
- Visible skill gaps and development needs
- Greater ownership of growth

Learning output: Participants understand why the course matters and how it connects to the leadership standard.

Materials: Slide deck, participant workbook, Leader Playbook reference.

Section 2: IDP Journey & Role Clarity

Time: 10 minutes

Slides: Slides 5-8

Purpose: Clarify the shared IDP process and the different responsibilities of employees, managers, leaders, and HR/L&D.

Key message: The IDP process is shared, but each role has different responsibilities.

Facilitator process

- Present the 5-step IDP journey: Reflect, Discuss, Plan, Document, Follow Up.
- Clarify the roles of employee, manager, leader, and HR/L&D.
- Run a quick poll to identify the step that feels most difficult in practice.
- Use responses to preview the rest of the session.

Discussion prompts

- Which IDP step is most difficult in real work?
- Where does the process usually break down?

Expected participant responses / evidence

- Employees may struggle to choose a goal.
- Managers may not have enough time for conversations.
- Plans may be too vague.
- System documentation may be inconsistent.

- Follow-up may be forgotten.

Learning output: Participants can describe the IDP journey and their own role in it.

Materials: IDP Journey Map; role clarity slide or handout.

Section 3: What Makes a Strong IDP

Time: 20 minutes

Slides: Slides 9-12

Purpose: Define the characteristics of a meaningful IDP so participants know what quality looks like.

Key message: A strong IDP is specific, realistic, connected to work, supported by action, and followed up.

Facilitator process

- Introduce the IDP Quality Checklist.
- Show the weak example: “I want to improve communication skills.”
- Show the stronger example that includes a goal, action, timeline, and follow-up.
- Ask participants to identify which quality criteria are visible.
- Debrief with emphasis on clarity, action, and follow-up.

Discussion prompts

- What makes the weak example weak?
- What makes the stronger example stronger?
- Which checklist items are visible?
- What would you still improve?

Expected participant responses / evidence

- The weak example is vague and has no context, action, timeline, or follow-up.
- The stronger example is specific, work-connected, observable, time-bound, and supported.

Learning output: Participants can recognize the difference between weak and strong IDP components.

Materials: IDP Quality Checklist and sample IDP cards.

Section 4: Fix the Weak IDP

Time: 15 minutes

Slides: Slides 13-15

Purpose: Give participants practice improving vague or incomplete IDP goals.

Key message: Weak IDPs can be improved by making the goal specific, linked to work, supported by action, and tied to follow-up.

Facilitator process

- Assign each group a weak IDP statement.
- Ask groups to revise it using the structure: goal, why it matters, action, support, timeline, follow-up.
- Invite 2-3 groups to share.
- Debrief using the checklist.

Discussion prompts

- What did you add to make the goal more specific?
- What action will help the employee practice?
- What support and follow-up are needed?

Expected participant responses / evidence

- Revised goals should include a concrete action, timeline, and follow-up point.
- Managers should begin to see how coaching improves quality.

Learning output: Participants produce one revised IDP example.

Materials: Weak IDP scenario cards; Fix the Weak IDP worksheet.

Section 5: IDP Conversation Model

Time: 15 minutes

Slides: Slides 16-19

Purpose: Prepare managers and employees to have a productive IDP conversation.

Key message: A strong IDP depends on a meaningful conversation, not only a written form.

Facilitator process

- Introduce the conversation model: Reflect, Align, Plan, Commit.
- Review sample questions for each stage.
- Model a short exchange using “I want to get promoted soon.”
- Ask pairs to practice two coaching questions and responses.
- Debrief useful language.

Discussion prompts

- What question would help clarify the promotion goal?
- How can the manager connect this goal to role readiness?
- What next step would make the conversation actionable?

Expected participant responses / evidence

- Managers ask open-ended questions.
- Employees explain readiness gaps and interests more clearly.
- Both agree on a concrete next step.

Learning output: Participants practice language for clarifying goals and agreeing on next steps.

Materials: Conversation model handout; question bank.

Section 6: CRM / System Guided Practice

Time: 25 minutes

Slides: Slides 20-24

Purpose: Help participants document and review IDPs correctly in the system.

Key message: The system supports the IDP conversation by making goals, actions, support, and follow-up visible.

Facilitator process

- Explain that the CRM is a support tool, not the whole IDP process.
- Demonstrate the core employee steps.
- Demonstrate the core manager steps.
- Use the Jordan Lee scenario for guided practice.
- Allow participants to complete role-based tasks in the system or simulation.
- Troubleshoot common issues.

Discussion prompts

- Which field captures the development action?
- Where should manager feedback be documented?
- How will the follow-up date be visible later?

Expected participant responses / evidence

- Employees can enter a goal, action, support, timeline, and progress notes.
- Managers can locate, review, comment on, return, or approve an IDP and confirm follow-up.

Learning output: Participants complete a sample system entry or review task.

Materials: CRM training environment or screenshots; system quick reference guide; Jordan Lee sample data.

Section 7: Draft or Refine Your Own IDP

Time: 20 minutes

Slides: Slides 25-27

Purpose: Allow participants to apply the learning to a real or realistic IDP draft.

Key message: A meaningful IDP starts with one clear, realistic development goal and a practical action plan.

Facilitator process

- Ask participants to work individually.
- Have employees draft or refine their own IDP goal.
- Have managers draft their own goal first or review a sample employee IDP.
- Circulate and help participants make goals specific and actionable.
- Remind everyone to use the quality checklist.

Discussion prompts

- What skill or capability are you trying to build?
- Why does this goal matter now?
- What practical action will help you develop?
- What support do you need?
- When will you check progress?

Expected participant responses / evidence

- Drafts should include a goal, action, support, timeline, evidence of progress, and follow-up checkpoint.

Learning output: Each participant drafts or refines one IDP component.

Materials: IDP Draft Worksheet; IDP Quality Checklist.

Section 8: Peer / Manager Review

Time: 10 minutes

Slides: Slide 28

Purpose: Improve draft quality through checklist-based feedback.

Key message: Feedback helps turn a general development idea into a stronger development plan.

Facilitator process

- Pair participants.
- Ask each person to share their draft briefly.
- Partners use the review questions to give one strength and one improvement suggestion.
- Participants revise their draft if needed.

Discussion prompts

- Is the goal specific and clear?
- Is the action practical and connected to work?
- Is there a timeline and follow-up checkpoint?
- What support could the manager offer?

Expected participant responses / evidence

- Feedback should be practical, specific, and focused on improving the plan.

Learning output: Participants improve their IDP draft based on feedback.

Materials: Peer Review Checklist; IDP Quality Checklist.

Section 9: Follow-Up Commitment & Close

Time: 5 minutes

Slides: Slides 29-32

Purpose: Confirm the next action after training and reinforce follow-up.

Key message: IDPs only become useful when they are revisited and acted on.

Facilitator process

- Review the recommended follow-up rhythm.
- Ask participants to complete one commitment sentence.
- Summarize the three embedded assessments.
- Point participants to post-session resources.
- Close with the core message.

Discussion prompts

- What will you do next to make the IDP useful?
- When will your next follow-up happen?

Expected participant responses / evidence

- Participants identify a concrete next step and a follow-up date or rhythm.

Learning output: Each participant leaves with a next-step commitment.

Materials: Commitment card; post-session resource list.

Assessment Plan

Assessment point	Evidence	Success criteria
Fix the Weak IDP	Revised IDP example	Goal is clearer and includes action, timeline, support, and follow-up.
System Practice	Completed sample entry or review	Participant completes required steps with limited support.
IDP Draft Review	Personal or sample IDP draft	Draft meets most quality checklist criteria.

Post-Session Transfer Plan

- Within 1 week: employees draft or update IDP; managers begin review.
- Within 2-4 weeks: manager-employee IDP conversation completed.
- Monthly or quarterly: progress check-in completed and documented.
- Before talent review: managers review IDP progress and update status.

Recommended Job Aids

- Manager IDP Conversation Guide
- Employee IDP Reflection Guide
- Sample Strong IDPs
- CRM Quick Reference Guide
- Follow-Up Email Template
- Manager Feedback Language Examples

Closing Script

Suggested closing message

An IDP is not complete when it is submitted. It becomes valuable when it leads to a clear conversation, practical action, and regular follow-up.